

STEAL This INSANE 1-Minute Market Maker Trading Strategy (75% Win Rate): Summary & Key Takeaways — Glimpse

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Market Maker Gamma: The 75% Win Rate Strategy Institutions Don't Share

Summary of the video "STEAL This INSANE 1-Minute Market Maker Trading Strategy (75% Win Rate)" by Chart Fanatics.

Institutional traders profit by understanding how market makers hedge zero-DTE options through futures, creating predictable price reversals at gamma levels. By reading the volatility surface and options flow, retail traders can identify where big money enters and exits, enabling high-probability trades with tight stops.

Why Options Flow Matters Now

Zero-DTE Options Changed Everything in 2021

The SEC allowed trading of options that expire the same day (zero days to expiration) starting at market open and expiring at close. This created explosive growth in options volume and forced market makers to hedge massive positions instantly, making their hedging activity visible and tradeable for retail.

Institutions Must Hedge Portfolios with Options

After crashes like 1987 and 2008, pension funds, endowments, and mutual funds realized they need insurance on their holdings. They use options to hedge multi-billion-dollar portfolios, creating predictable demand that market makers must manage.

Options Volume Exploded Post-2021

Options trading volume on indices surged dramatically after zero-DTE launch. In one month alone, the options market grew 300% month-over-month. This represents trillions in daily hedging activity that creates measurable price moves.

How Market Makers Move the Market

Delta Hedging Forces Futures Buying/Selling

When a market maker sells an option, they face unlimited loss risk. To stay delta-neutral (zero directional exposure), they buy or sell the underlying futures. As price moves, delta changes, forcing them to continuously re hedge—creating a self-reinforcing buying or selling pressure that moves the market.

Gamma Acceleration: The F1 Car Effect

Gamma measures how fast delta changes. With zero-DTE options, gamma becomes extreme near expiration—like a Formula 1 car at 300 km/h that must steer sharply. Market makers must hedge more aggressively and quickly, creating violent price moves and reversals at key levels.

Volatility Surface: The Weapon Institutions Use

Institutions trade volatility, not direction. When they buy options, they create a spike (cone) on the volatility surface, attracting price upward as the market maker hedges. When they sell, they create a pocket that price falls into.

Understanding this 3D surface is how institutions trade with precision.

Gamma Walls and Cold Walls: Price Magnets

Gamma concentration at certain strike prices creates 'walls'—levels where the market maker's hedging pressure is strongest. Price is magnetized to these levels and reverses sharply when it reaches them, because there is no more hedging to do above or below.

How to Trade Gamma Levels

Identify Maximum Gamma Levels Using Options Data

Use platforms like Guestbot to visualize open interest and gamma concentration on the volatility surface. The highest gamma levels (biggest red or cyan bars) show where institutions are positioned. Trade reversals at these levels with tight stops.

Trade Frequency and Position Sizing

This strategy generates 1-2 high-probability setups per day. Risk 30-50 ticks (\$150-200) to make \$2,000-3,000 per trade. Use 2-3 NQ contracts to allow partial profit-taking while keeping one contract running. Win rate of 75% means one stop loss every 2-3 weeks.

Convexity Levels: Secondary Confirmation

Convexity levels (derived from volatility surface peaks and pockets) provide secondary entry and exit points. Positive convexity bars show rejection zones; negative convexity (purple bars) shows weak support. Trade positive convexity to positive convexity for high probability.

First Two Hours Matter Most

Institutions position themselves in the first two hours after market open (9:30 AM–11:30 AM ET). Gamma and delta hedging are most predictable during this window. After lunch, charm (time decay) becomes dominant and less predictable, so avoid trading late in the day.

Avoid OPEX and Triple Witching Days

On options expiration days (monthly OPEX, third Friday, and triple witching—when index options, stock options, and futures options all expire), market maker hedging becomes chaotic and unpredictable. Skip trading these days.

The Psychology and Discipline Required

Stop Losses Are Emotional Triggers; Mindfulness Helps

A stop loss activates the amygdala (fight-or-flight response), causing cortisol spikes and irrational decisions. With a 75% win rate, one stop loss every 2-3 weeks hits hard emotionally. Mindfulness practice and understanding your physiology (heart rate, breathing) help you stay calm and avoid revenge trading.

Risk-to-Reward Ratio Protects Against Emotional Bias

Risking 30-50 ticks to make 300-400 ticks creates a 1:8 ratio. This asymmetry means even a 50% win rate is profitable. With 75% win rate, the math is so favorable that discipline becomes easier—you trust the process instead of fighting emotions.

Take Time Off After Stop Losses

After a stop loss, your nervous system is flooded with cortisol. Your prefrontal cortex (rational thinking) shuts down. Take 2 days off to let your body recover and your mind reset. This prevents revenge trading and account blowups.

Key Concepts and Terminology

Delta: Directional Exposure

Delta measures how much an option price changes when the underlying moves \$1. Delta ranges from 0 to 1 for calls. A delta of 0.5 means the option is at-the-money and has 50% probability of expiring in-the-money. Market makers stay delta-neutral by hedging with futures.

Gamma: Rate of Delta Change

Gamma measures how fast delta changes as price moves. High gamma near expiration means small price moves cause large delta changes, forcing aggressive rehedging. This is the core of the strategy—gamma concentration creates predictable price reversals.

Theta Decay: Time Decay

Theta measures how much an option loses value as time passes. With zero-DTE options, theta decay accelerates dramatically in the afternoon (especially after 1:30 PM), making positions unpredictable. This is why trading is best in the first two hours.

Implied Volatility (IV): Market's Expectation of Volatility

IV is the volatility baked into option prices. When institutions buy options, IV spikes (expensive options). When they sell, IV drops (cheap options). The volatility surface maps IV across all strikes and expirations, showing where institutions are positioned.

Convexity: Exponential Payoff of Options

Options have exponential payoff—small moves create large gains, but this payoff flattens as the option goes deeper in-the-money. Institutions exploit this by taking profits at the peak of convexity (gamma peak) before the payoff flattens.

Real Trade Examples

Example 1: SPX Put Wall Trade (420 ticks = \$2,000)

Price approached the maximum put gamma level (put wall) at 5,550. Market rejected it, reversed, and rallied 420 ticks. Entry at the wall, stop loss 30-40 ticks below, target the next gamma level. This exemplifies the core strategy: wait for the level, enter, manage risk tightly.

Example 2: NDX Convexity Trade (384 ticks = \$1,900)

Price moved from one positive convexity level to the next. Entered at the first level, exited at the second. Convexity levels act as secondary targets when primary gamma levels are unclear. This trade took 15 minutes on 5-minute candles.

Example 3: Double Bottom (Not a Pattern, Positioning)

Traditional traders see a 'double bottom' and expect a breakout. In reality, two separate institutions positioned at the same gamma level, creating two reversals. Understanding this prevents false breakout trades and shows why gamma levels are magnets.

Notable quotes

This strategy has 75% winning rate. My edge is to enter when the big guys enter. — Freddy Siento

If Goldman Sachs is there, I'm going to reverse all my position. — Freddy Siento

Don't be afraid of complexity. Spend time to understand this because this is what's moving the market. — Freddy Siento

Action items

Subscribe to Guestbot platform (use 65% discount link) to visualize gamma levels and volatility surface in real-time.

Identify the maximum put gamma and call gamma levels for your preferred contract (NQ, ES, or SPX) using 90-day open interest data.

Trade only the first two hours after market open (9:30 AM–11:30 AM ET) when gamma hedging is most predictable.

Set stop losses at 30-50 ticks and target the next gamma level or take profits at 300-400 ticks.

Use 2-3 contracts to allow partial profit-taking while keeping one contract running to capture larger moves.

Avoid trading on OPEX (third Friday), triple witching days (Mar/Jun/Sep/Dec), and spiration days (30 days before OPEX).

Practice mindfulness meditation for 8 weeks to manage emotional responses to stop losses and prevent revenge trading.

Track your heart rate during trading to recognize when cortisol spikes indicate emotional bias.

Take 2 days off after a stop loss to let your nervous system recover before resuming trading.

Study the volatility surface relationship: buying volatility creates spikes (price rises), selling volatility creates pockets (price falls).

Learn to distinguish between positive convexity (trade) and negative convexity (avoid) bars on the Guestbot platform.

Combine gamma levels with order flow or footprint analysis to confirm institutional positioning and market maker hedging.

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